

Test 1: Listening, Part 1 (page 20)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear two friends talking about attending a motor-racing event.

- M:** It's brilliant what they've done to improve the track, isn't it? It's faster and there's more room for overtaking. Everyone was there to have fun and that made for a great feeling in the crowd.
- F:** It was a wonderful day out. It's such a thrill to see and hear the cars. The race itself was less exciting than I'd been expecting but the mood of the spectators made up for it. It was a bit difficult to find the exit though. They need more signs to show how to find the car park when you're leaving.
- M:** Mm, we did get a bit stuck in the crowd on our way out.

Extract two

You hear a football coach talking about a match.

- M:** After losing an important match, as a coach, you go over and over what went wrong. You wonder if the players had had enough training beforehand. In this case, they'd been training every day for months. Physically they should have been strong and fast enough to win, but the pressure and expectations make it difficult sometimes. I reckon they had so many thoughts going through their minds that they weren't thinking about the game itself, but more about winning the cup. That led to some crucial mistakes that allowed the other team to score even though they were probably the weaker side when it comes to fitness.

Extract three

You hear two people talking about a computer game.

- F:** Have you been playing your new computer game? What do you think of it?
- M:** Actually it's quite hard to get the hang of. The way it operates, it takes an awful lot of practice. There are so many stages before you really understand how to play it well, but that's the whole point. Some people don't find that very interesting, but for me that's the fun of it, trying to work out how to beat the game if you know what I mean. The worst thing is, it costs far more than I reckon it's worth. Probably because of all the TV advertising.

Extract four

You hear a woman talking about judging a poetry competition.

- F:** It was fascinating judging the Young Poet of the Year Award. It seems many young poets today are putting aside traditional dreamy views of trees, flowers and rivers in order to tackle more everyday life topics. As you might expect, some of them showed great ability in seeing the funny side of life and dealing with it in an amusing way. When discussing the poems as judges, we discovered something remarkable. Of the 150 finalists, at least twenty had more than one poem; one, more than a dozen. We weren't judging one-offs, we were looking at young poets who wrote all the time and continuously developed their work.

Extract five

You hear a young man talking about travelling alone for the first time.

- M:** When I finished college I decided to go travelling on my own around Europe. We lived in a small town and I'd only ever been on a few short trips abroad with my family before. Anyway, I'd been planning the trip for some time, but hadn't told my parents because I thought they'd be anxious thinking something could go wrong. When I finally announced the news to them, much to my amazement, they just sat down and spent the rest of the evening looking at maps and giving me advice about what to take. I'd been wondering if they would explode furiously and tell me I couldn't go.

Extract six

You hear part of a talk by a nurse.

- F:** Caring for people is hard work, but you're giving people something they need. You never know what's going to happen – every day on the ward is different and you meet loads of different types of people. Most, but not all, are pleasant to deal with so being friendly but calm is a vital quality. There are plenty of options about the type of people you work with, so some deal with young children, or others prefer the elderly patients. One thing is the shifts – you often have to work weekends and nights, but the schedules are quite flexible and you can earn more.

Extract seven

You hear a man talking about a long-distance journey he made.

- M:** The trip took three days and although I could have got there in about two hours by plane it wouldn't have been such fun. A lot of people think speeding down a motorway for hours on your own is boring, but it's the feeling of being a part of the environment that I love. Having passengers around you talking and eating is something I'd rather avoid. You can get a bit sick of wearing a crash helmet all day, but what I spent on that and my other protective gear was worth it – when night fell, the wind got very bitter and I saved on fuel in the end.

Extract eight

You hear two friends talking about listening to the radio.

- M:** Do you listen to the radio much?
- F:** Not usually, but in fact I woke up this morning to the sound of my mum's playing in the background and I really got into the programme that was on.
- M:** What was it?
- F:** There was a discussion on about building and construction and I got hooked right away, even though the subject isn't particularly relevant to me or my life. There were some real experts talking about it and even the presenter seemed impressed by their knowledge of the subject. It's funny how interesting something can be even though you wouldn't expect it to be.

Test 1: Listening, Part 2 (page 21)

You will hear a singer called Tim Tanner, who sings with his twin brother Sam Tanner, talking about their lives and career.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi there. My name's Tim Tanner, and I usually sing with my twin brother, Sam Tanner. I'm going to tell you about our career. Sam and I've been pretty famous as the singing twin brothers for about three years and we've appeared on lots of TV shows including *Summer Holiday Special* and *Funtime*, which is the talent

show where we were voted best act – you probably saw it. It's the one where the people in the acts had to be related to each other. After that we had four hit singles in a row and I guess the rest is history really.

People often ask us what it's like to be twins who've grown up looking so alike. Sam and I've shared almost every experience, and we're never usually apart for more than an hour at a time. I was born ten minutes before Sam so officially I'm the older brother, although we do actually have a real older brother, Ken, who's a year older than us.

We were born premature, you know – earlier than we were supposed to be. Mum says it was hard carrying both of us when she was pregnant, and she was quite relieved when we suddenly appeared in October rather than January, over two months earlier than expected. Our big brother Ken's birthday's in December – so we're pretty close in age – it must have been tough for our parents with three young boys.

Sam and I aren't completely identical, but most people can't tell us apart. It's only mum who never mixes us up. Even our dad makes a mistake sometimes calling me 'Sam' and my brother 'Tim', because there's hardly any difference in our hair, and we're the same height and build. But as soon as we open our mouths, he'll know which one it is by the voice. Sam's is a bit deeper than mine, but most people don't even notice that.

In character we're quite similar – we've both always loved music, and since we were five we've wanted to be pop stars. We've always had a real interest in going out, and being sociable too. I'm a bit shyer though – people that know us say I'm not as confident as Sam is, which is probably true. Although I'm not exactly shy, you know. After all, you can't appear on TV if you are!

At school we used to pretend to be each other sometimes for a laugh. Sometimes we'd swap places for spelling tests but nobody noticed because we got the same marks, which were pretty low – we were better at sports, and both played in the school football team. I was also good at basketball, but Sam wasn't as keen, preferring volleyball for some reason.

We were both much more interested in music. I began learning the guitar and he started proper singing lessons with a private teacher when we were about thirteen, but a year or so later we both got into dancing in a big way and then we went to a special school where we could do loads of stuff that's turned out to be useful – things like drama.

We share everything, and have one phone and computer between us and we get on well almost 100 percent of the time, but of course occasionally we have a row, usually about shoes because we share them too, but if we both want to wear the same ones for a show then we'll argue for about 20 seconds and then one of us'll give in and it'll all be over. We manage to share the computer pretty well without fighting over it, which some people might find surprising.

Our image is based on being twins and looking alike and because we both have poor eyesight we enjoy choosing different styles of glasses for performances, you know, maybe green ones, to go with green suits, or dark ones with T-shirts and jeans. So the glasses are a major aspect of the way people see us on stage.

And look out for some new looks on our next tour, to promote the new album which is called *Time Dance* and comes out in a few weeks. It's got some exciting new songs on it, quite different from our first album *Soul Brothers*. Sam and I wrote all the new songs together.

Test 1: Listening, Part 3 (page 22)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about classical music.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) the reason each person gives for starting to play classical music. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

Classical music's often seen as old-fashioned and though there's people everywhere who go to concerts, and some classical musicians are big-name stars, it doesn't really excite young people that much; they prefer pop music or more modern stuff. But the truth is, it's hard to interpret complex music, even with the best

teacher in the world, unless you start training early on in life. Luckily for me, I came to this conclusion myself when I was in my early teens, and when I said I wanted to become a classical guitarist, my parents rather reluctantly went along with the idea and bought me some lessons. Since then, I've played almost every day.

Speaker two

I bought my first classical recording aged fourteen. It was a violin concerto by a Russian composer. Although my school had a strong arts focus, I'd no particular interest in classical music till one day when I heard a big rock star going on about 'the most exciting piece of music ever written'. Being a fan of his music, I felt I had to hear it. By the third listening, I was convinced he was right. What's more, I found I really had an urge to play the violin myself – and found myself a teacher. Despite my dad's complaints about the noise I produced, I practised every day at home. I've never looked back.

Speaker three

At my school, I was made to learn the recorder, and I had to practise every day. The sound I produced was so dreadful that whatever piece of music I was supposed to be playing was hard to recognise, despite all the efforts made by our music teacher, who'd actually been quite a famous musician himself when younger. It took a while, but I recovered from that, and got to know the work of some of the top composers thanks to my uncle. That got me excited enough to beg to have piano lessons when I was about twelve. After that, everything just took off. Now here I am getting quite well-known as a concert pianist.

Speaker four

At school, our music teacher tried to get us into classical music without much success – he just seemed to go for the most unexciting pieces. It was me who noticed classical music turning up in movies, cartoons and stuff. Like, I remember one day hearing a really famous classical piece being played on a commercial trying to attract young kids to some fast food place. You'd think things like that'd be enough to put anyone off classical music, but they had the opposite effect on me – encouraging me to want to learn to play and seek out a good teacher, which is what I did, much to my mum's amazement, I remember.

Speaker five

Although my dad had taught me to play the flute at an early age, I didn't get interested in learning to play classical music then. I wasn't willing to try and understand it and didn't realise you have to do that in order to enjoy it. As a kid, I wanted something that made me jump and got me going – made me feel happy or enthusiastic, so I resisted the efforts of my teacher to introduce me to classical music. She got there in the end though, by sheer persistence, convincing me that there's great excitement to be found in the joy of playing something difficult, and doing it well.

Test 1: Listening, Part 4 (page 23)

You will hear an interview with a professional athlete called Ann Brown.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: Today I'm talking to 21-year-old, long-distance runner Ann Brown, who's just returned from the World Championships. So, Ann, how did you feel about your performance in the championships?

Ann: When you haven't raced for a while, you've no idea whether you're in sufficiently good shape. I'd only had a few weeks of training behind me so I wasn't thinking I'd do brilliantly, and it certainly would've been amazing to come first. Anyway, I was happy to get the silver medal. It was an exciting race and the crowd was fantastic.

Int: So what's your training routine like, Ann?

Ann: I do around 25 to 30 hours a week, mostly long-distance, steady stuff. I go running through the woods. Running on roads is pretty dull so I make sure there's always some attractive countryside to keep me

interested. I get pleasure from seeing the changes in nature, but I do have to remember to keep my eye on the time so I can check my pace. It's vital to keep pushing myself to my limits.

Int: Do you train every day or do you take a day off?

Ann: The accepted idea is that all professional sportspeople should have at least one rest day a week, so the body can recover. I'm not a great believer in that though. At my age I find I can keep going without one. I do five hours a day and I'd even like to be able to do more than that, but I don't want to push my body too hard, because that can lead to other problems.

Int: What about your competitors in races – do you get to know them as friends?

Ann: I race against athletes from all sorts of places. I wouldn't say I've got friendships with them, though I'm sure some of them are really good guys, but I tend to keep a professional distance. It'd be too easy to let friendships start interfering with the way I run races. Of course, at my age chatting about life, having fun and a good social life are important to me. I share a house with three mates. They're the people I really get on well with.

Int: So do you have any favourite free time activities?

Ann: Let me think. I suppose I did when I was a kid but I'm not so sure nowadays. Yeah, I used to take my kite to the top of the hills and fly it for hours. In season, skiing's something that I get into quite a bit when I've got the time. I've always enjoyed active things, and never really been much of a reader of books or that kind of thing. Of course, I watch TV and play computer games like most people.

Int: And do you get recognised in the street very often?

Ann: Very rarely, I'm pleased to say, as I think it'd be a bit strange and I'm not sure how comfortable I'd feel about being stopped for autographs and pictures all the time. On the whole I find people wanting your autograph a bit of a pain to be honest. It happens sometimes when I'm at events and at first you say OK, and then after a while you wish it'd stop. I suppose I did that sort of thing when I was younger. It was always such a thrill to meet someone in the public eye.

Int: So are you planning for the next Olympics?

Ann: Well, in my sport most people peak in their late twenties so it's important to have an eye on the next five years or so, cos that's when supposedly I'll be at my best. In the immediate future I want to do well of course but I'm concentrating my attention further ahead. Fortunately, I've been injury-free so far – so I don't have that worry. It's no use having fantasies about winning gold medals until I've reached the top of my own fitness and endurance levels. Then I can start to think seriously about it.

Test 2: Listening, Part 1 (page 43)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear two friends talking about a book.

- F:** It's unusual to see you reading a book on science. I've read that too. What do you think of it?
- M:** This? I got it for my birthday. It's written in a way that's supposed to be funny – with cartoons and stuff. I think my older brother thought it'd be good for me – you know teaching me about science which I'm not that interested in really.
- F:** So are you enjoying it?
- M:** I've got to read it really because my brother'll ask me about what I've learnt – there aren't many pages to get through at least. I'll be glad to finish it, though I bet I'll forget everything I've read once I do.

Extract two

You hear a man talking about family holidays as a teenager.

- M:** My memories of family holidays as a teenager are of being dragged away from my video games to spend hours in the back of the car making the time pass by listening to my favourite bands on my headphones on the drive to our family's holiday home. There the entertainment on offer was swimming in the river, or lying in the sun and going for walks in the forest, things I'd absolutely loved not so many years before. I'm embarrassed to admit I insisted on staying in the basement with the curtains drawn watching action movies. Meanwhile, the rest of them had fun swimming, walking and playing in the sunshine.

Extract three

You hear two friends talking about a hotel they stayed in.

- M:** I don't think I'd recommend that hotel to anyone.
- F:** You can't expect luxury for that price. Anyway it was easy to get into the city centre so we managed to see all the sights.
- M:** It was a good starting point for exploring, but the people working there weren't terribly helpful when we asked them for directions.
- F:** The lady on the reception desk was nice I thought, and you must admit she gave us a room overlooking the garden at the back.
- M:** It's a shame about that tiny bathroom though. The beds could have been softer too.
- F:** We should have read some reviews online before booking.

Extract four

You hear a woman talking about a new film.

- F:** It had quite an old-fashioned style – very simple in that you basically follow a single character on a journey with plenty of adventures along the way, unlike a lot of modern movies where there's so much activity and noise that it's difficult to follow what's happening. I hate films that leave you feeling miserable afterwards because of the ending – this one avoided that, but even though the story kept you interested, I ended up feeling annoyed that things didn't go how I thought they should've done and I wanted it to be more realistic – so you could believe in it.

Extract five

You hear a woman telling a friend about her job in a supermarket.

- M:** You're working part-time in the local supermarket in the mornings, aren't you? How's it going?
- F:** It's OK – I don't mind it when I'm taking cash and serving customers – I get to chat with them, but putting cans and packets on the shelves all morning can be hard work. When you're on one of the special counters that serve fish or bread and cakes, it's easier because you don't get that many customers. I hope I get put on there again tomorrow like I was today. I spotted some lovely fresh prawns and bought them with my staff discount.
- M:** Working in a supermarket has its advantages!

Extract six

You hear a man talking about a band he saw at a concert.

- M:** When the band came onstage they were looking extraordinary, dressed in a peculiar but visually dramatic style – all in black and gold with make-up to match – a look that basically worked even if it was bizarre. The concert soon got going and when they played their biggest hits the talent of this group of musicians was apparent to all, with an astonishing version of 'She's got that thing'. It seemed they were just getting warmed up when they left the stage and despite calls for more never returned, leaving many a bit let down after the high spirits of such a brief performance.

Extract seven

You hear a sports instructor giving advice.

- M:** One technique you can learn is how to float at your body's true length, which will let you move more smoothly through the water. Take a relaxed breath. Fall forward onto your chest and lie flat. Extend your arms over your head, so that your arms and legs reach their full length. You'll find your legs will sink, which is natural, but reduces speed. You'll want to lift your head. Try not to and instead push your chest down. Your hips will lift and, to a certain extent, so will your lower half. As your lungs fill with air, you can float at your natural body length.

Extract eight

You hear a woman talking about being at university.

- F:** At university, it was important to remember I was there to get a degree because there were lots of other activities to do. I only ever missed the occasional lecture, which is a bad habit to get into. I never had enough money to go out anyway. I was studying in the evenings a lot of the time. I didn't think the whole thing would go by so rapidly and before I knew it I'd graduated. I'm going to make sure I keep in touch with the people on my course. They were great fun and I needed discipline not to just try and have a good time.

Test 2: Listening, Part 2 (page 44)

You will hear a woman called Grace Connolly talking about her travel experiences in New Zealand.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi there. My name's Grace Connolly and I'm just back from a fantastic trip to New Zealand. It really was the trip of a lifetime, and I'd like to tell you all about it.

New Zealand has two main islands – the North Island and the South Island. I went to the South Island and it's even more beautiful than I'd expected. There are many ways to see it – you can hire a car and drive, or some people go around by motorbike – you can even see the island by boat, but I went on what's known as the green bus. Our driver was so helpful and really helped to make it a memorable journey.

So, what route did we take? Well, we started in Nelson, in the northwest of the island. Then we headed off down the west coast stopping at various places and then inland up to our final destination, Christchurch on the east coast, the second largest city in New Zealand.

I also went on a day tour to a place called Kaikoura, which is a hundred and fifty kilometres north of there. It's on the coast and is famous for its sea life and also for being one of the most exciting places in the world to see ocean birds. To really experience the day you have to opt for one of these trips. It was dolphins I was keenest to see, but there are whales too. It was an absolutely amazing day.

I made so many new friends on the trip, which was always fun. There were people from all over the world, Korea, Russia, North America ... I've stayed in regular contact with a girl I met from Japan. Most of us were quite young, but there was one guy from Germany in his sixties.

New Zealand's famous for the sports you can do, but it can work out expensive to hire the equipment you need to do things. You had to pay rental charges and so on for everything. I actually took my own bike along with me, and did a fair bit of cycling around. I rented a surfboard for a day or half day, and though it was more expensive, I also went out on a quad bike one day.

But the highlight of the trip for me was jet boating at place called Buller River. I'd strongly recommend *Adventure Tours*, the company I did it with – nothing was too much trouble and they really made it fun and exciting. I didn't try the other company, which was called *Great Days*, but friends said it was OK too.

Every trip has some problems – I fell and hurt my shoulder horse-riding on a beach. Luckily the sand was soft enough to prevent it being anything serious, and I didn't need treatment. But then I actually had to go to Christchurch Hospital after doing something to my foot – climbing over some rocks. Anyway, it was nothing major and was fine after a couple of days.

There are interesting things to buy on the South Island. Nelson Saturday Market's brilliant. There are stalls selling food – honey, bread and fruit – all sorts of things. I got a fantastic wooden mask as a souvenir, but there were also paintings and jewellery and stuff that would've been nice to bring home too.

The accommodation was great the whole way – the hostels we stayed in were all good. Like *The Fairway* in Christchurch, or my favourite *The Lakeside* in Nelson. That's the place I'd advise anyone to stay. If you go, say Grace told you about it!

I'm already planning a return visit to New Zealand – to North Island this time. It's got famous mud pools and hot springs, which I might get to visit, but sightseeing's not my main aim. In fact the reason I'm going is that some friends have offered to take me walking with them round all the best places. I'm really looking forward to it.

So before I go on to ...

Test 2, Paper 4: Listening, Part 3 (page 45)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about a radio station.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each person says about it. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

The station I listen to has the right balance of talk, sport and news and a great mixture of presenters but there are far too many advertisements. In the mornings I usually listen to a short news programme and then a show about sports going on both locally and nationally which is presented by a well-known ex-sports star. The thing I like about the station is that it has stuff for all age groups. There are a lot of good comedy shows and quizzes, but also stories about people and places in the area and it makes itself accessible to even the youngest members of the community.

Speaker two

It's a locally operated radio station and it broadcasts some of the top nationally rated talk radio programmes. There are live shows 24 hours a day and you can listen online if you prefer. I've enjoyed listening to it for many years now. I especially like one very amusing comedy programme which is on every weekday night and the *Science Fantastic* programme on Saturday evenings. I prefer this station to some of the national ones and I like the local news stories, although sometimes I'd rather it took more notice of news and other subjects from overseas, rather than just the local area or the country as a whole.

Speaker three

I tend to listen to the radio a lot and I love the arts show – that's the selling point for this station for me – the presenter is very serious about the arts and his in-depth approach helps me keep up-to-date with all the latest theatre, books and movies. Oh, and they don't broadcast advertisements so you never get interruptions when you're enjoying a show. I've given up flipping through channels to avoid them now. Another thing is they don't have news every hour like so many stations. There are some really good quality radio dramas – it's an excellent way for young writers to get their work broadcast.

Speaker four

Talk radio has grown in popularity in my area and there's a huge demand for more and more talk-show stars. My favourite station has a show called *Viewpoint*. It's presented by a very entertaining guy and sure, there'll be those out there who may not agree with his opinions, but that doesn't matter because he makes fun of everything. So, even if you don't agree with him, you can sit back and enjoy the humour in his approach to local or national news events. I find I'm still one of the few younger listeners to this station though – most of my school friends don't really go for it.

Speaker five

I even got a chance to go on this radio station myself. It was kind of embarrassing but quite fun because not everyone gets to go on a radio show and meet the presenters. All the shows are really interesting. They also play a lot of fun games – and talk about popular issues. The station's known for sponsoring charity organisations in this region, so it's offering more than just entertainment. There's one programme where they're training young newsreaders so they picked out about thirty kids from nearby towns and are training them to be newsreaders and they get to do one short show each.

Test 2: Listening, Part 4 (page 46)

You will hear an interview with a woman called Penny Greer, who works as a photographer.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: Penny Greer is a successful photographer, who runs her own company. Penny, is it important to take a college photography course if you want to do this work?

P: I think so – it changed my life. I'd already realised how creative taking photos could be, and my college course was heavily commercial, which put me off at first. My idea was that photography was 'art' and I had little interest in taking photos to sell things. I'm glad I got over that, but above all what I learnt there

was how to use light and to apply that understanding to whatever I want to shoot. Once you get that, you lose the fear of making mistakes.

Int: What made you specialise in wedding photography?

P: After college, I did some work for wedding photographers who had quite traditional ideas of how to express the character of the event. A wedding's an emotional day, and photography to me is an emotional process. I'd never thought about it till then, but putting the two together made sense. I was keen to experiment with breaking the rules by being more a fly on the wall – catching what's happening without interfering.

Int: Then you set up your own company – how do you attract customers?

P: I've advertised a lot in the past year, and built a good website to showcase my work. I have print ads in a few wedding magazines, and ads on their sites. The thing that's really worked is the postcard. I get a mailing list monthly of new brides and mail out postcards. I get over eighty percent of my calls, meetings and bookings from this source. The ultimate goal is to get the majority of business through personal recommendation.

Int: How do you spend a typical working day?

P: I'm usually stuck at my computer, mostly editing and working on the jobs I shot the previous weekend. While doing this, I also deal with phone calls and emails from interested customers and set up meetings. About a tenth of my time's meeting clients and getting to know them and only around a fifth is actually shooting, the rest is working on the shots to prepare them for presentation.

Int: How do you get what you want in a wedding photo?

P: Obviously it has to capture the powerful emotion of the occasion. I find it's when everybody's comfortable because nothing's worrying them – that's when they stop acting for the camera and I achieve what I'm looking for. Some weddings I photograph, the couple want things a little different – they wear something unusual and their guests have to wear special clothes, so the photos turn out pretty bizarre. Those shots can be the most fun to take.

Int: What do you love best about your job?

P: Now I have greater freedom to move in different directions – my decisions are trusted and I don't have to try and adapt to the various tastes of other people. I'm both scared and proud to make my career choices and being my own boss is something I couldn't live without. In the early days it was fulfilling to be able to create and work on the shots from beginning to end but now I'm hoping to take on an assistant to deal with certain parts of the process.

Int: What advice do you have for younger photographers?

P: The more you shoot, the more you grow. Some people worry they'll end up with too many photos but you just have to learn to delete them. It's not about doing something different at every job. It's more about using the camera until you're 100 percent confident in what you're doing. Sometimes it works, sometimes it doesn't, but I always learn from it, and it keeps me fresh. Besides, once you start running a business, you don't always get to shoot as much as you'd like, so do as much as you can now!

Test 3: Listening, Part 1 (page 62)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a hotel manager talking about the staff who work for her.

- F:** I think I've managed to build up quite a good team of staff here at the hotel, although of course there's always more you could do. When I started, there was a bit of a tendency for leaving early among some of them and I had to be firm in putting a stop to that. I don't think people should get fixed in one particular role, so I have them rotating their duties – reception desk, waiting, cleaning – from week to week, and if I see someone shows talent, I recommend they try for further training or something like that.

Extract two

You overhear a student talking on the phone.

- M:** So well it's OK Mum. I've not done much actual studying yet. More just registering for the library, things like that. I've got as far as meeting all my teachers, and I'm happy that they all seem nice. And I've settled into my room now, you know, got pictures up on the walls. It's really close to everything, the centre, the campus. There are loads of other students in the same building, of course, and they seem OK, most of them, so I expect I'll get to know them over the next few weeks.

Extract three

You hear a caller on a radio phone-in programme.

- F:** Yes, I'm calling about the way some colleges are cancelling training courses. I was listening to the last caller and I thought it's terrible, this business of simply telling people no, sorry, it's not running after all. In my case, I'd paid a deposit, I'd arranged to have the time away from work, so when the course was cancelled it was really bad news. I'm sure there are other listeners out there with the same experience. So, what can be done about it? Who's responsible?

Extract four

You hear a man talking about a wildlife documentary.

- M:** Overall, this documentary is worth watching. I'm not sure it's going to win an award this year, however, since it's short of being really inspirational. The locations are great, but in some ways the camera work lets the rest of it down. I'm not saying there's anything actually poor, but by today's standards, I'd have expected tighter close-ups, a few more night scenes using infra-red techniques. I think this is particularly true if you're going to feature the kinds of smaller animals that they went for here, ones that don't naturally fill the screen. The voice-over was strange, very downbeat, almost flat, which actually gave an odd sense of excitement to it.

Extract five

You overhear two people talking in a café.

- M:** I'm so sorry I am so late ...

- F:** Don't worry. I was fine, checking my messages here ...
- M:** I got here as quickly as I could, but just as I was leaving the office, I got a call from the camera shop to say my photos of my friend Richard were almost ready ... but they had some questions – 'just take a moment, sir' – well, it was a funny kind of moment!
- F:** No problem ...
- M:** Anyway, they'll be done just in time to pick up tonight, so I can take them over to Richard's house after this.
- F:** I'm sure he'll be pleased.

Extract six

You hear a man talking about how he designs light shows for music concerts.

- M:** Well every show's different, of course, a fresh challenge. What works brilliantly in one venue may flop in another, so I always focus on the idea of the audience, how they will experience the performance ... and then I try to bury myself in the music they'll be playing, playing it over and over again, until it's inside me, until I start to get a main idea, and then I refine that. I might also look at some classic films, like old black-and-white ones, to get ideas about light and dark, contrast ... it depends on the kind of music I'm dealing with.

Extract seven

You hear two friends talking about a new 'free bike-hire' scheme.

- F:** What this city needs is a free bike-hire system, like they have in some other places. It would do a great deal for the quality of life here. And it's up to the local government to pay for it. It'd probably reduce bike thefts as well as reducing traffic congestion!
- M:** Well, I'm not sure about the crime angle, but the environmental benefits for the city would be clear. But I think it needs wider involvement than just the local council. It's *such* a serious issue ...
- F:** Well, it's not a national issue like gun crime or something, is it?
- M:** No, but it's a deeper problem than people seem to appreciate.

Extract eight

You hear a woman talking about her favourite movie.

- F:** Yes, I'd say that is my favourite film of all time. Ever. There is no limit to how many times I could watch it, and every time I watch it, I'm still absolutely hooked, to the exclusion of all else. I mean, yes, I fully acknowledge that not that much actually happens. Maybe it is a tiny bit slow by today's standards, but the laughs still work, the jokes are still well delivered, and there's just enough romance involved to make the whole thing quite sweet – and the last line is still one of the best in any film.

Test 3: Listening, Part 2 (page 63)

You will hear a museum director called Carl Halford talking about the museum where he works.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi there. My name's Carl Halford and I work at the local museum, where I'm the director. The museum's recently re-opened its antiquities section which has been closed for over a year. Let me tell you all about it.

Firstly, we wanted to give it a complete new look. As you know, the Museum was founded in 1902 and remained unchanged, barring the extension in 1958, until our last renovation project in 1973, so it was high time we freshened things up a little. We've made a lot of changes and not only to the exhibits themselves. Like, we've replaced the display cabinets and so on. People notice new cabinets and signs, but often not the fact that the lighting has been improved, although it can change the whole way they see an object. And it's an area in which great technical progress has been made in the last few years.

So, what about the exhibits themselves? We've altered the selection on show. Part of our collection of around 650 objects is actually still stored underground, and so we've got 429 out on display, compared to 390 previously. A significant change we've made is in the organisation of the exhibits, so that where before they were grouped according to their place of origin, we've now created a pathway through the museum that allows you to view them in order of age, starting with the oldest as you enter the gallery. We've also provided more information on the signs, such as who first discovered them, how we think they were used, and so on.

I'm often asked to talk about some of your favourite pieces. And it's hard to choose. But there's a fascinating cup, just a simple cup, which is over four-and-a-half thousand years old. Round the side you see this quite lovely flower pattern and then if you pick it up and look underneath you can see the shape of a leaf there. It's a sort of mystery as to why someone would have put that there. And it's survived so long.

Another little mystery is a little set of figures. There's a farmer with two cows. Although they're certainly not horses or oxen, they do seem to be ploughing a field. But it's not 100 per cent clear, because one's pointing forward, the other's pointing the opposite way, so how would that work? We'll probably never know.

The exhibits attract all sorts of visitors – young and old. Though some of them are a bit scary for younger children. Like there's one statue that's got a big head with lots of curly hair, and eyes that seem to follow you round the room. You notice kids looking back at them nervously. It's obviously a deliberate part of the design. And in fact, a lot of ancient art was about terrifying things.

Like there's a special vase, which we've lovingly restored, that's painted all the way round with this amazing scene. You see this man, the hero, sailing with his soldiers and then battling with a monster, and yet, we're not told – we don't know the outcome, who wins that fight!

But there's a lot that's interesting on a smaller scale too. We've included quite a few coins in the display, because they're such good tellers of historical tales. There's one of a famous emperor that's special because the decoration on it is remarkably detailed, and you'd never think so much information could be included in one small object, but you can see the shape of his ears, his nose, and so on. At the other end of the artistic scale, we have a small rock, just a basic, natural thing, not a statue, but we like to think about the young man – we assume he was a young man – out by the river, and how he carved, or just scratched, the image of a fish onto it. Perhaps he caught an extra big one, and wanted to celebrate the fact. Again, we'll never know for sure, but I love the simplicity.

So before I go on ...

Test 3: Listening, Part 3 (page 64)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about what makes a good teacher.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says a good teacher should do. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

I fully accept that everyone's different, so of course different teachers will suit different types of children and teenagers. Throughout my education, though, the teachers I responded to best were the ones that tried to push me along a bit by getting me to try a little bit harder. Because the problem for me is that I'm naturally quite a lazy person, and I've always been more interested in life outside the classroom than inside it. So I'm the kind of person that's perhaps a bit of a headache for teachers, the sort they're not really thinking about when they're studying for their teaching qualifications.

Speaker two

Most of the time a teacher's just doing his or her job, I guess. I mean, they've done their qualification, they're in the classroom, they've got to write your report at the end of term saying how you've done, haven't they? Sometimes, you might want to be able to ask your teacher something before or after class, get some advice or extra information, or tell them about some problem. It's the teachers who're there for you in those situations that are special, who take an individual approach. And I don't think it's too hard for them to do that, give you a couple of minutes.

Speaker three

Well, I'm a firm believer in the importance of the subject. If a teacher can get the kids absorbed by the subject, be it maths or geography or cookery or whatever, then the job is basically done. The best teachers are the ones who make it look easy, because they make it seem fun. Then the kids are fascinated, even amused, by the subject, so they want to learn, and each and every one of them makes progress. I think this often involves the teacher getting everyone to see the relevance of the subject in the wide world, beyond the confines of the classroom.

Speaker four

Fashions come and go in teaching, just as in everything else. We're at a stage at the moment where there's a lot of focus on the individual, and getting every child to take responsibility for their own learning, that kind of thing. But you can't just tell kids to be better, to study harder, you also have to demonstrate what you mean by this. So the teacher needs to put in the hours, to mark the homework, to prepare lessons carefully. If kids know the teacher's doing it, then they'll want to do their part too. I think that's the way to do it, never mind what's in fashion.

Speaker five

Perhaps the best thing is for teachers to reflect on how they themselves got to be teachers. How did they achieve success in their qualifications? How did they manage to do well at school? It's down to a question of each and every student making his or her own way – and they only know if they're doing well if they're told by their teacher that they're doing well ... or badly. You need to be told the facts about how well you're managing with your studies, in class and in your homework. The truth is that learning's not a game, not just fun, but hard effort.

Test 3: Listening, Part 4 (page 65)

You will hear an interview with a singing teacher called Rosie Carnes, who is talking about her work.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: My guest today is Rosie Carnes, who teaches people to sing. Rosie, is it difficult to sing well?

R: Well I guess the first thing to mention is that when we sing, we ourselves cannot truly know how we sound to anyone who's listening to us. We have to sense what it must be like through a combination of what we can hear and what it feels like to make sound. When I was a child and I created a sound I felt excited. When I take in breath, I know I'm not just taking in air, I'm taking in the basis of sound. That's exciting too!

Int: And is it important to warm up before you sing?

R: Yes, you'll ruin your voice if you're not warmed up, and you'll sound rubbish. Your throat is quite small, and it's what you have to push the air through into your mouth, which is what will frame your music. But in fact you need to begin with your spine, which wants to be stretched and made flexible. That way, your whole body is prepared. The importance of whole body readiness cannot be overstressed. The way you stand affects the way you sing.

Int: And your knees are important apparently.

R: That's right. Your knees want to be over your heels rather than the balls of your feet, and not completely straight, but a little angled. Avoid crossing your legs tightly, or pressing them against each other, because you'll be too tense.

Int: And to maintain your voice in good condition?

R: That's crucial. As a professional singer, you've got to look after your voice, your pride and joy, your source of income. If you get a cold or an irritated throat, steam is usually very effective at reducing the inflammation, so get a bowl of steaming water and sit over it with a cloth on your head. If that's not possible, sucking a sweet or two may help repair the voice – although the important thing is keeping it in good condition in the first place, for which you need to drink anything up to eight glasses of water every day, and avoid smoky places, shouting, that kind of thing.

Int: And what about learning the words of songs?

R: That's a big part of being a singer. There are various ways of trying to push the limits of your memory, but mine's never been very strong. I've driven several friends to the edge of despair when they're trying to test me, and now I go it alone, going over them again and again and again during the course of an ordinary day, until the meaning sinks down into me. It's never easy. Anyway, it takes all sorts, and I hope that people will find their own way.

Int: What advice do you have for wannabe singers?

R: Well, nothing is easy about singing. It's all hard work, I'm afraid to report, but then the rewards are beyond anything else, so it's a fair deal. So, if you're wanting to have a career as a singer, and if you've got a good voice, then treasure it. Don't panic if it does get hurt – it's impressive how it'll recover. The important thing is to use it. Get out there. Take every chance you can to sing in public. This experience will also help to feed and build your ambition to go on, to be better. Singing on stage to an appreciative audience is as good as life gets.

Int: And if public performance isn't your thing?

R: Well, if you've got a good voice – then maybe you'll be like my friend Diana. Although she conquered most of her anxiety about performing in public a few years ago, she still prefers studio singing, performing directly for CDs and so on. Nobody really sees her outside her home and the studio. Even warming up her voice for a recording performance is something she does in private, making weird noises while sitting in her car outside the studio building. I think she's alarmed a few passers-by in her time!

Test 4: Listening, Part 1 (page 80)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a man talking about a book.

- M:** It's what I guess is usually termed a historical novel. By which you might expect a novel of history, but here I think we can say it's simply that it's set in the past. Basically, they ride horses instead of getting into cars, that kind of thing. I'd have liked to have had a little more historical material than that in fact, to have learnt a little more about the period. But anyway, the style is excellent, really flowing and there are some great 'word pictures' that definitely captured my imagination. There are even touches of humour here and there.

Extract two

You hear a caller on a radio phone-in programme.

- F:** Yes, I'm calling about the new swimming pool and sports centre complex. Unlike some of the callers I've been hearing, I have actually looked at the plans and visited the site where they're going to build it. I know some people have doubted whether we should have such a building at all, but I can definitely say, as a parent with young children that it is necessary. The old pool is only an outdoor one and it's useless in the winter. But as I say, I've seen the plans and I worry that it's going to look very out of place – like a kind of weird spaceship, so I want to ask if it's too late to change that.

Extract three

You overhear a conversation about families.

- F:** I must say I envy you your knowledge of languages – three, is it?
- M:** Yes, though I don't usually think about it. I mean, you see I grew up with Dutch and English ...
- F:** Your father's Dutch?
- M:** My mother. She always wanted to maintain the two languages with us children.
- F:** But your wife speaks Spanish? And you live in London?
- M:** Yes, and she's determined that *our* kids will be bilingual, so we speak 'her' language in the house, and English for outside – and of course the kids at school. And then I get to chat in Dutch in the holidays.
- F:** Impressive.

Extract four

You hear a woman talking about learning how to make jewellery.

- F:** I've come to really enjoy my jewellery-making classes. I wasn't at all sure at first, and my friend had to talk me into going with her. But it's great – I always thought I was so hopeless at anything involving actually doing or making things with my hands, but it turns out I'm not so rubbish after all. But it is quite

a battle – there are so many techniques to learn, and one silly mistake can mean you've ruined a whole piece you've just spent hours on! Anyway, I hope it will eventually lead to the chance to use what I'm learning – maybe even earn some money from it!

Extract five

You hear a man talking about a new car he's just bought.

M: I'm pleased with my new car so far. Mind you – I spent ages deciding which model to go for, reading magazines, checking specifications on websites and stuff. There's so much to consider, and of course the running costs are a major issue. But let's not kid ourselves that a car's ever going to be actually cheap – it costs money even when you're not using it – though I think this one's perfectly reasonable. It came down to parking for me in the end, and with this one being so small, I can get it into pretty much any space I find. So let's just hope it was the right choice.

Extract six

You overhear two sales assistants talking about their new manager.

M: What do you make of the new manager?

F: I'm not sure yet, really. But he seems less than completely charming, doesn't he? I mean, he just gives you orders, doesn't make an effort to be pleasant at the same time.

M: I guess he doesn't see that as a vital part of the job ...

F: Hmm, he might be more into efficiency, perhaps, though we don't have any evidence of whether he'll be successful yet. But he's got all the certificates and he clearly knows all about management theory. That's why he got the job. It'll be interesting to see how it works out in practice.

Extract seven

You hear a man talking about a tennis competition.

M: I'd say that was a great first attempt, and that everyone involved should feel very proud of what they achieved, whether playing or organising in some way. The competitors definitely had a good time. It went well, and was more popular than the local paper described – we had a lot more people there than they said. I hope that next year there'll be even more people watching, as the event gets better known. Everyone will tell a few others about it, and we can do more posters and things next time. Meantime, I think I better get some practice in!

Extract eight

You hear a cycle mechanic talking to a customer.

F: I'm worried you won't be able to fix it this time.

M: Well, there will come a day when we can't repair it, but I don't think we're there yet. But it's going to take a while to do it, because we'll have to wait for the replacement parts to be delivered – there's only one place left now that supplies them.

F: And expensive?

M: I'm afraid so, relatively. But if you love your old bike, then it's not about price, is it? But I can work it out for you first, so you can decide for yourself.

F: No, let's do it.

Test 4: Listening, Part 2 (page 81)

You will hear a woman called Britt Foxton talking about women's basketball.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi my name's Britt Foxton, and I'm the founder of a website devoted to women's basketball, and I've also just written a book on the same subject. But first up, let me tell you how I got started with the site.

Although it really got going once I was at university, it actually started out as a high-school project – you know a 'design a website' kind of thing – but it wasn't like anyone expected it to become real or anything. I designed a site about girls' basketball, which I was passionate about, and called it femalebasket.com – I knew the name wasn't right, and before it got really successful I changed it to matchgirl.com – and that was a really good move.

And although it started with basketball, the site's kind of evolved to include other games as well. It features a variety of articles, reviews and editorials on everything ranging from basketball to computer games, plus a smattering of more traditionally 'girly' material as well. But the coverage of team sports is at the heart of it – anything about make-up or fashion is just peripheral.

Then there's my book – that was a quite different sort of challenge. It's on the subject of girls' basketball and overall took about three months to do. I knew I wanted to write it late last year and started to loosely plan it out in January of this year. It wasn't until May that I had enough time to get down to doing everything I'd envisioned. But it was all done by the end of July.

And in researching the book I came across some pretty interesting facts. Like, women actually began playing basketball less than a year after the men's game was invented, back in 1892. It didn't become an Olympic sport until 1976, however, whereas the men's game was in there from 1936. And that tells you a lot about how it developed.

People ask me whether we'd recognise the game the way it started, or if it's changed. Well, the biggest difference is in clothing. Back then in the USA, women were required to play in full-length dresses. The only body parts that could be exposed were fingers, necks and heads. And it wasn't only the discomfort they suffered, it led to a quite a few broken bones because players tended to trip over their skirts and stuff. Of course no way did the men have these problems!

Then, at the end of a woman's game, there'd be like handkerchiefs and hairpins scattered all over the court, which of course wasn't the case with the men either! So you can see how the two developed in quite different ways – even with a differently sized court for many years.

Of course, things did change – but quite slowly really. Appropriate clothing came in gradually, but even well into the twentieth century some other rules applied to women, but not to men. Not so much the equipment, but silly things like chewing gum was specifically prohibited in the women's game because it was considered unfeminine, not because it was dangerous or anything!

And I've got some good stories from those years in the book, I think. Like when in 1936, a team of women basketball players called The Red Heads toured the country playing exhibitions against men's teams. Strange thing was though, these girls not only had to wear the same clothes, they all had to have red hair – most of them had to dye it specially! Isn't that unbelievable!

But looking back on the writing of the book – If I did it again, I'd do it all differently. I know I ought to be proud of what I've done, but I'm such a perfectionist. Given the chance, I'd add significantly more information on the cultural traditions and really address the growing basketball fan base. But who knows – maybe there's another book in there somewhere!

Now before I show you some ...

Test 4: Listening, Part 3 (page 82)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about holiday jobs they have done.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about the job they did. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

I'm glad I took the job – if nothing else, it's taught me that I never want to do it again! It was just what I had expected, really, although maybe a bit harder. Packing things into boxes and boxes into crates – it's never going to be fascinating, is it? But actually, it wasn't the actual tasks themselves that got to me – because you can just go into a sort of dream world, do it on automatic while thinking about other, nicer things – but the way everyone went for breaks and lunch at exactly the same time every day. The others were OK, you know, I mean, not rude or anything, so I shouldn't moan.

Speaker two

It wasn't at all easy, you know, but I'd thought it would be a breeze. I guess the thing with being on the reception desk in a hotel – even a budget hotel ... or maybe especially a budget hotel – is you never really know what's going to happen next. You might find yourself dealing with an incredibly rude guest – tell yourself he's very stressed – or someone who's locked out of their room, or anything. Some days were so busy you couldn't catch your breath, and others dragged by. My manager was great, really positive, but some of the other staff were just, well, dull.

Speaker three

When I first finished the job, I thought I'll never do that again, no way. But now that I've recovered a bit, I think I might well try to do it again next summer. With tips, the money turned out to be quite good, and some of the other waiters were quite funny, so it kept me amused. Every day was pretty similar to the last, and the next, and I found that quite reassuring. It was tiring, being on your feet all the time, and having to smile and be nice and show an interest in everyone and laugh at some pretty terrible jokes – all that was what took the energy ... but, yeah, I'd do it again.

Speaker four

Well, I was working in this shop. It sold small craft things, you know, models and little pictures and things, mainly to tourists really. I didn't exactly have a lot of responsibility – if anything interesting happened, like a delivery, or a customer spending a lot of money – then I had to get the manager to come and deal with it. She was rather a cold person, actually, though very polite. But it wasn't very good weather and there weren't very many tourists, so most of the time I just sat about, to be honest, or did a bit of gentle tidying of the stuff on sale.

Speaker five

I didn't understand what was involved when I got the job. I thought working on a campsite meant helping people put up their tents, stuff like that, but I found I had to do cleaning, and also serving in the little shop they had there. There were a couple of other guys working there, but they kept themselves to themselves and the boss was nowhere to be seen, ever. So problems landed on my plate, and I got shouted at or treated badly by families turning up late and finding we didn't have any spaces, or that their tent had a hole in it or something – but nothing was my fault so why blame me like that?

Test 4: Listening, Part 4 (page 83)

You will hear an interview with a novelist called Greg Field.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: My guest today is the novelist Greg Field! Greg, you started writing quite young. Were you into books and reading as a kid?

G: Well, funnily enough, my parents were always on at me to read, they couldn't understand why I didn't like it much. But if we went to a library, it was all serious and silent and slow and not lively at all. One summer, though, I was in my grandma's sitting room and she had this whole pile of books, which she let me play with because I liked the covers. And I started leafing through, and then maybe reading a word or two, and then a page, and then that was it.

Int: And what about at school?

G: Well, in fact school added another dimension. We'd got schoolbooks, of course, history books and maths books that we'd work through, though I much preferred finding out about stuff online. But there was one particular teacher we had, who at the end of every day would get out a book, maybe poems or a story and read them to us. It was like music, like a film – these great pictures his voice summoned up in my mind: and that's when I knew I had to be a writer, so I could make that happen too.

Int: So how did it feel when you eventually achieved that?

G: Well I was so scared when I was writing my first novel – scared that nobody would read it, that I'd never finish it, or I'd lose it, or that the publisher would change her mind, etcetera, etcetera ... I can't tell you what a relief it was to see it on the shelves in a bookshop. Then the next one was, by comparison, a bit of a disappointment – the reviews were pretty bad, and it never sold as well. But these days, I just have this nice, calm feeling about the whole business.

Int: Tell us about where and how you write.

G: I write in a small room at the top of my house. There's no sound, no music, no traffic, and that's what I need to get a sense that my words are filling something. I've tried writing in other rooms in the house, but I find it harder to settle down to work. I don't use a computer, just a pen, any kind of pen, I don't have a special one anymore – losing it was too traumatic – and I do look out of the window a lot. And I drink cup after cup of tea. And, yes, it's a special cup!

Int: So tell us about your next novel?

G: Next is a book for teenagers – at least, I hope they'll like it – I've never tried writing one before. It's set about a hundred years ago, and it's about school-age children in the country, who are sent off from their farms to work in a factory at a young age, and the hard times they have. Like all my historical novels, it has a serious message, but there are lighter moments too.

Int: Any advice for budding young writers out there, Greg?

G: Well, if it's your first book, does that mean first person? People often write their first book about themselves and from the 'I' perspective. Of course, you're likely to write best about what you know, to be most convincing, but bear in mind that if you do that there might be a lot of stuff you can't include. And your readers may want to know about other things that you don't see.

Int: Anything to avoid?

G: Well, it's very dull if you set everything in the same place, of course, or always have them wearing the same clothes. Their choice of clothes can tell you about a character's personality. And an important aspect of writing fiction is the use of symbols, for example, the weather representing how people are feeling. But resist the urge to spell everything out. 'The sky was grey', fine, not 'the sky was grey and John felt as grey inside as the sky was', etcetera.

Int: That sounds like good advice – thanks Greg ...

Test 5: Listening, Part 1 (page 98)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a man talking about long-distance swimming.

M: My interest in long-distance swimming grew out of my gentle weekend splashabouts at the local pool. I found I was starting to do lengths, and then lots of lengths, until finally my friends were going: 'What? You do how many – two hundred? I don't believe it!' People think I do it for the challenge, but actually what appeals more is that it's so different to everything else I do. My job's so chaotic that I never have time to stop and think. I do get a bit lonely sometimes, if I'm out there, going across some big lake or whatever, so it's lovely when everyone's waiting for me on the other side.

Extract two

You hear a woman talking about a film she saw.

F: If I'm absolutely honest, I didn't really enjoy the experience. And I wasn't even looking forward to going in the first place. I don't usually find thrillers or horror films very interesting and I always think I can tell what's going to happen next, making the whole exercise seem a bit pointless. This one, though, was genuinely frightening, partly just because it was just so loud, but there were some real shocks that had you jumping in your seat. There were people near us who were actually laughing, but I think that might have just been to cover up their nerves.

Extract three

You overhear a conversation in a restaurant.

F: Mine's delicious. How's yours?

M: Yes, it's good. I've never had it before, although I've often seen it on menus in other restaurants. The flavours are beautifully combined, and it's really quite hot – fills the mouth. In fact, I didn't realise it would be so fiery. I could do with a nice cold drink to help with it. But, yes, it's good, and you can tell the ingredients are all completely fresh.

F: Why don't you have some of my water until the waiter comes back?

M: Thanks.

F: It does look pretty on the plate, doesn't it? Mine's nice too – would you like to taste a bit?

M: Please.

Extract four

You hear a man talking about a holiday.

M: Yes, the holiday worked out OK in the end. It exceeded my expectations actually. I guess, because the island was definitely more interesting than I thought it was going to be. When I was booking the trip, though, the travel agent told me what an exceptional hotel it was. I think he went over the top a bit, or perhaps had just never actually been there. Still, I wasn't going to let that spoil my enjoyment,

because basically it was the best one around. The whole package wasn't particularly cheap, I have to say, but since I had such a good time I can't really complain, can I?

Extract five

You hear a woman talking about an old camera.

- F:** Ah, that old camera! It was really like a friend – it went everywhere with me, and it had plenty of marks and scratches on it to prove it! I never even bought a case for it or anything, and it worked fine. But it was old technology really and I thought I'd better get a more up-to-date one. So, in the end I sold it for a few pounds – more than it was worth really. I wish I'd held on to it though, because I do miss it. I've got album after album full of photos I took with it, and it's actually quite easy to upload them onto a computer and they look fine.

Extract six

You hear a television newsreader talking about his job.

- M:** I love the unpredictability in my job – you just don't know what the news will consist of until, literally, it's going out live on air. Throughout the day, stories pour in. Quite a lot of them are just routine and later get set aside, whilst others develop into big news items. Sometimes it's down to a reporter happening to be in the right place at the right time – you can't plan world events, so you just hope you've got someone on the ground when something happens. We do make kind of loose plans at the start of each day, but any of that might be dropped later if a big story breaks.

Extract seven

You hear part of an interview with a prize-winning musician.

- M:** So you've won the Musician of the Year Award. That must be a great feeling.
- F:** Oh yes. I'm still trying to realise it's true. I know my parents are very proud of me and I'm very lucky to have that level of support and encouragement. I wouldn't have ever done it without them. I can't say it's a great surprise, because for the effort I've put in, there had to be a chance I'd win. But as the finals drew closer, and I saw just how good the other performers were, then I started to worry, and now I feel I've been a bit lucky, cos I could easily have missed out.

Extract eight

You hear a man talking about the experience of going to university.

- M:** Well, I've settled in now, and I feel quite at home. It was all a bit of a shock when I started, though, so different from how school had been. The teachers were all strangers, and did things differently to the ones we'd had in school, but I guess I'd been prepared for that and soon got used to their methods. I lacked confidence socially, though, and somehow everyone else seemed to have been friends already, so I hesitated to approach anyone. I became very focussed on my studies, determined to manage my time well and get high grades. Gradually, I started to mix more. But it took a while.

Test 5: Listening, Part 2 (page 99)

You will hear a woman called Carly Clarkson talking about her career as a street-dance teacher.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi there. My name's Carly Clarkson, and I'm a dancer. I've come along today to tell you about the type of dancing I do. It's called street dancing.

Basically I took up street dancing because other types of dance weren't available to me. Some of my friends had ballet lessons, or tap-dancing lessons as kids. But we were quite poor so we couldn't afford anything like that. I did a bit of gymnastics at school, that was useful, but apart from that I learnt on the street. I was quite happy with that because it was part of who I was and it reflected the way I lived. I guess you could say that it was my culture. That's what I always tell people anyway!

I learnt to dance when I was out on the street with my brothers and their friends – just in the local park. They were really into all kinds of break dancing stuff, and I used to hang out with them. I saw my brother do a move called a windmill, which is a brilliant move, and I just thought: 'Wow I want to do that.'

And, of course, now I teach street dance and people ask how I got into that. I guess I wanted to be able to give kids opportunities I'd never had myself. I've been teaching street dancing for ten years now, and to all sorts of ages. I teach anything from four upwards, but I have taught sixty-five-year-olds. I guess the best age to start is around five years old though.

I teach in different studios. I have my own performing arts school, which is called Footsteps, and that's where I'm based, but I go out as a freelancer too; going into other studios, to dancing workshops in the community, as well as working with kids in schools too.

So, is it always fun? The answer is yes, mostly. It's certainly not stressful or anything. But when you teach, you give away a bit of your soul and sometimes people don't always appreciate how much hard work goes into it. That sometimes can get a little bit frustrating. But, you know, you have to rise above it.

And interest in street-dancing is growing. A number of people have asked why that is. And, you know, it's partly that you see it now on TV and there've been a couple of good films. But I think it's mostly because of the fact people aren't getting enough exercise, and so the government is now taking notice. So people like myself are now paid to go out and promote healthy exercise. Maybe it comes better from us than from doctors or sports coaches.

And I suppose, if you want to get young people fit and active again, then you've got to do something that's seen to be quite a cool thing to do, and that's where street dance comes in. Other types of dance like ballet can be seen as a bit snobby, or contemporary dance is a bit arty, but street-dance isn't like that.

I'm also sometimes asked whether, for someone who hasn't got any natural rhythm, it's possible to become a professional street-dancer? 'And I'd say definitely. I'm not sure that natural rhythm's the thing actually, as long as you have good general fitness, you can learn. But you must have discipline and ambition to become a professional. I mean, nine times out of ten you don't get the job you're going for. There's maybe, say, 12,000 street dancers and a hundred jobs, so unless you're right up there it can be tough.

Finally some advice for any of you thinking of taking up street dance as a hobby. I'd say, see what's available locally – an Internet search should get some results. Failing that, I'd say go along to your local gym and try and find out what classes are available. If you're at school or college, ask to have a freelancer like me come in and do sessions at an after-school club or whatever.

So, before I go onto ...

Test 5: Listening, Part 3 (page 100)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about a charity running event.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

It's a very worthwhile event, and one I'm pleased to be involved with. If you just wait around for people to give money to charity, they probably won't, or won't give very much anyway. But if you can say, 'look we're running all this distance, what do you think, can you sponsor me?', then people will tend to give quite a bit. You do need to make sure you're up to the event itself, though. As we were running along, we passed some

others who I think hadn't really put the training in, poor things, and they were suffering a bit. But hopefully they still raised some money by doing it.

Speaker two

Well, it's held every year, you know? The first time I did it, it was a mistake – I just wasn't ready and I had to give up halfway through. Very embarrassing. Luckily, there weren't too many of my friends watching me that year! I've since got myself more organised and I do a proper training routine, with the result that last time I got round in my quickest ever time and that's made me feel pretty good about myself, to be honest. Not least because I raised a fair bit of cash for the charity as well as having a great time on the day and generally keeping fit.

Speaker three

It's very important that this kind of event takes place, because it's the only way serious sums of money are going to get raised for the charity. I have to admit to being a little frustrated in some ways, though. Like, you're supposed to be sent your race number beforehand, so you know where to stand for the start on the day, but this year nobody had received theirs. I mean, that's typical of how badly the event's run. Not important maybe, but it's enough to put some people off taking part. Anyway it was great to see the spectators out in good numbers – they can always be relied on to show up.

Speaker four

It's a wonderful event, well organised and a lot of money's generated for a worthwhile charity. I took part for the first time two years ago, and my friends who'd come along gave me a big cheer, which I wasn't expecting! When it was time for this year's race, I didn't feel I was fit enough, so I decided to give it a miss. Then felt guilty and decided at the last minute to enter after all. It was a big mistake because I felt horrible all the way; out of breath, cramp, the lot. I felt a fool, though I did still manage to meet the money-raising target.

Speaker five

My friend encouraged me to do it, and we did our best to get fit before the big day. I didn't want to crash out before the finish because I'd set myself a goal in terms of the sum I wanted to raise, and didn't want to let people down. There was pride at stake too, I guess. It must be incredibly complicated in terms of organisation, with so many runners and such an enormous band of spectators along the route – I just couldn't believe the size of the crowd – it really gives you a boost! I was relieved to finish in one piece and I want to do it again next year.

Test 5: Listening, Part 4 (page 101)

You will hear an interview with a woman called Sally Gartree, who works as an organiser of the three-day Ixford Music Festival.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

- Int:** My guest today is Sally Gartree, who works as one of the organisers of the three-day Ixford open-air music festival. Sally, I think you've been involved with the festival for quite some time, haven't you?
- S:** Yes! I remember it being set up first some twenty years ago, when I was just a kid, and I think it was fourteen years ago that I went for the first time myself – I *made* my parents take me – and then I went absolutely every year after that. I was asked to join the team of organisers eight years ago, and I can't imagine ever stopping now.
- Int:** And I guess you've seen some changes over the years.
- S:** If you look at the festival these days, in the evening, there are twinkling candles and little fires almost as far as the eye can see, spread across several fields – there's always been a lovely atmosphere once the sun goes down. But in the early days the whole thing fitted into just one field, and it wasn't a

big one either – just enough for everyone's tents and the stage. That's been the biggest change. Although of course all the performances were in the open air then too, there was no covered stage.

Int: Any regrets for the way things have changed?

S: Not really. And the big-name bands expect high-quality facilities these days. Actually, if you ask me, the performers are perhaps reducing in importance for audiences in some ways, and that's a shame. There are more and more stalls appearing selling exotic foods and you almost get the feeling that's what a lot of the crowd have come for. Although there's always been those who just want the souvenir T-shirt, of course, to say they've been.

Int: But there's still a lot to be enjoyed, surely?

S: Definitely. There's some great music, although I'm not so keen on the way it's broadened out into pop music myself. But there's something for everybody at the end of the day. It's the company that really makes it for me – everyone just seems so calm and ready just to have a good time. These days though, I have to say I tend to wander back to my tent and fall asleep not much after midnight – I can't keep going all night like some of the others, or like I used to.

Int: Anything you'd like to change about it?

S: Well, we can't control the weather, and it's been rather wet some years leading some people to suggest moving everything indoors but that would spoil the fun for me. I do wish though that we could persuade more people to leave their cars at home – because congestion's a real headache. We do state really clearly on the adverts that we'd rather everyone used public transport, but they take no notice. It's strange because the adverts are quite effective in other ways.

Int: Any good stories about the stars?

S: Sure. We've had so many musicians here, and a lot of them have gone on to become very famous, whether because of the festival or not I couldn't say. One guy, I remember – let's not use his name here – agreed to come back and play for a very modest fee. He played his set, and then some more, and then joined in with some of the other guys, and he just didn't seem to want to leave the stage. Afterwards he said he just loved being here, and I think a lot of them feel that way about the festival.

Int: So what of the festival's future, Sally?

S: I think we've achieved the optimum size actually. The programme of performances is as full as it can get, realistically, and I imagine we'll always resist the idea of being broadcast on television – because that's just not what we're about – so I personally wouldn't be in favour of expanding things further – though of course that's not just up to me, and there are those who'd like to go to four days, or bring in another field. I guess we should be happy that it carries on being so successful.

Int: Indeed. Thanks Sally.

Test 6: Listening, Part 1 (page 116)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a woman talking about the gym she goes to.

- F:** For me, the key thing in keeping yourself fit is doing a range of activities, not just one thing over and over again. I've joined this gym, and I hope that's going to be helpful. There's quite a lot of different equipment, and it's all the latest stuff, and the best stuff on the market at that, so I mean to try as much of it as possible. They also run various classes, which seem to be popular. Group activities, and planned timetables aren't really my thing, although I might have a go if my friend Sarah comes along too. She's always saying I should do more of the group stuff.

Extract two

You hear some information on a travel programme.

- F:** The holiday business is a mixed picture this year. Holidays at the seaside have a constant appeal, don't they, that combination of sun, sea and sand? Having said that, the market seems pretty static and while hotel owners may be frustrated at the lack of growth, I think you'll find the beaches are still full. Meanwhile, more people are staying inland, and we can see a rise in short breaks to capital cities – perhaps they're quicker to get to, perhaps the unreliable weather's having an effect here. On the other hand, the rising costs of activities such as climbing and skiing seems to be driving more and more people off the mountains.

Extract three

You hear part of an interview with a man who teaches people to ride a bicycle.

- F:** Tony, you teach all ages to ride bikes. You must notice some big differences.
- M:** I teach mostly children, but some groups of adults. Actually, the kids are often rather serious about the whole thing, but with the grown-ups you get quite a lot of laughing. But they're just as nervous, probably more so – the learning process is a challenge for them. They worry about looking silly or stupid, and feel bad when they get things wrong. Some of them do give up, and I always feel sorry for them, that I've let them down, much more so than with the kids, but there's not much I can do at that stage.

Extract four

You hear a businesswoman leaving a phone message.

- F:** Yes, hello, it's Caroline. This is the second time I've rung, so I hope you get this message. I'm a bit concerned about the situation. As I understand it, the planning meeting that was scheduled for Thursday has been postponed by at least a week, which may mean that it has to be cancelled altogether. Both the Managing Director and I are likely to be away on trips by then, so the whole thing would be further delayed. It's all a great shame. Can you get back to me when you can and clarify why the meeting might be put off and also if it could be moved by only a couple of days? Thanks, bye.

Extract five

You hear a man talking about how he gets ideas for his work.

- M:** People ask me where I get my ideas from and it's a good question. I say: 'Look, ideas come from ideas, right?' So I might watch movies, any kind of movies all day for a week, until I'm hypnotised, spinning with images, but with the stories waved away, so just pictures, and then maybe I could start to work with those ... those ideas ... to translate them into paintings. I read poems, too, lots of poetry, but I read it wrongly, backwards, for example, till the images become separated, just ideas for compositions that I then realise on canvas, *my* ideas.

Extract six

You overhear a woman talking to a sales assistant in a shop.

- M:** Can I help?
- F:** Yes, now as I explained to your colleague on the phone before I came down here, this isn't the model I was looking for when I bought it. I can't connect everything I want to it, like the wireless link and also my printer, so it doesn't work for me. I'm quite prepared to spend a bit extra, but you should take this one back and give me the more up-to-date model. To be honest, I think the sales assistant who sold it to me just wanted to make a sale – she wasn't listening properly to my requirements.
- M:** Let me just get the manager for you.

Extract seven

You hear two friends talking about a rock concert they went to.

- M:** What did you think of the concert then? Saw you up there on the balcony.
- F:** It was awesome – at least Sally Rydout was – but an old-fashioned theatre's a funny place to hold a rock concert. It was like all gold paint and red carpets everywhere.
- M:** Oh I thought that was cool – anyway I got my ticket at half price cos my dad knows someone who works there.
- F:** Hey – you might've said – you could've got me one too. Cos I didn't think the support bands were up to much actually.
- M:** No – same old stuff – glad I didn't pay full price!

Extract eight

You hear part of a programme about websites.

- M:** So you've been looking into some more websites for us this week? What type were they this time?
- F:** I've been looking into sites that are based on people's hobbies, an area traditionally served by magazines, you know, motorbikes, horse-riding – that kind of stuff. And there's quite a variety of sites out there, and some of them are full of attractive design – some very clever features – but most of them lack sufficient content. I guess I thought I was going to find something a bit more engaging to be honest – I mean something that the magazine itself doesn't already offer.
- M:** Right.

Test 6: Listening, Part 2 (page 117)

You will hear a student called Erica talking about learning how to do make-up for the entertainment industry.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi there. My name's Erica. I'm a final-year student at Woodlands School in Thornbury and, together with my twin brother Steve, I spent a week at the local college doing a course in make-up skills for the entertainment industry. It was a kind of work-experience scheme and I'm here to tell you all about it.

On the course, you can do, like, various diplomas depending on what you're interested in. I had a choice of hairdressing, which is not quite my thing, manicure, which I didn't feel quite ready for, or beauty studies, which I went for because it seemed to give the basics.

Now, in case you're wondering. This wasn't a week off school. It is schoolwork, we're just not in the school building – and we're in with kids from other schools, which is cool. It's good because we all wear these black tunics rather than our usual school uniforms. Given that mine's actually purple that's, like, such a relief.

We practise on dummies with wigs rather than real people – and we learn how to apply different types of make-up or whatever. Like, on day one we kicked off with hairspray – you know keeping it off the face and stuff – and later in the week got to apply eyeliner and use make-up to get people's skin looking older or younger.

And we had formal lessons too. A history teacher from another school did one about stage make-up through the ages, then our chemistry teacher came and told everyone about what's really in shampoos and stuff – I mean that was brilliant. Then one afternoon a maths teacher came – I can't remember the exact subject, but it was something relevant.

Doing the course has helped me to see whether I'd want to do make-up as a career – or maybe something related. I'd like to work for a cosmetics company one day. I mean it could be in the research department, but I'm not that good at sciences, and given that my dad's in marketing I guess that's the department I'd rather end up in – but who knows? Whatever happens, I think this hands-on experience is really useful.

And, of course, I was there with my twin brother, Steve, but this isn't the first course like this he'd done. The college also does courses in drama, set design and other stuff related to entertainment. Steve did one in costume design, but didn't have the patience for it – but at least he had the chance to find that out.

But I think he does have an interest in make-up. I remember when we were five, we locked ourselves in the bathroom with my mum's make-up bag. We wanted to do a bit of face painting and Steve used her lipstick. Fortunately it was a cheap one. She had some really expensive face cream and eye make-up in that bag, but luckily he never spotted it! Anyway, we made a real mess and it went down in family history – so they were all reliving the memory when we were doing this course!

Steve thinks the hands-on stuff is great. He found learning how to make fake cuts with blood really cool apparently. But the classes are good too. We both learnt a lot from the one on lighting. It's surprising how closely that's linked to make-up in all types of entertainment actually, but especially on stage.

And Steve might be headed for a career in make-up. There's plenty of opportunities actually. People immediately think of theatre work or the film industry when you talk about make-up, but he'd be more interested in going into fashion. Make-up's big business there too – both for live shows and photographic work.

And we've both already got work-experience placements lined up for when we leave school. We were pretty lucky. We wrote off to all the local theatres of course – not thinking we stood much chance – but also to a local advertising agency. And it's them that's taking us both on. They make videos for the local television station and the Internet and stuff. So it should be really interesting.

We're both really looking forward to it ...

Test 6: Listening, Part 3 (page 118)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about being given advice.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker was advised to do. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

Yes, it was my uncle who gave me some great advice some years ago, and, looking back, I can safely say he saved me from doing something I know I'd have come to regret later. I was struggling with the decision about where to study medicine – my idea was to stay near my home town rather than go further away. I felt nervous about leaving my family, my friends, the safe little world I knew, but my uncle just sat me down and told me some stories about the things he'd done and seen in his life, and you know what? None of them had happened in our little town, and he made me see it was better to get out and see something of the world.

Speaker two

One bit of great advice I had was from my mum. I'd finished university and I was at a loss as to what to do next. I didn't really have a clear idea of how my life should progress. I was hanging around the family home, feeling really rather sorry for myself, and wondering if university had been such a clever idea after all. This friend of mine asked me one day to come along and help him make a wedding video, because his assistant was off sick or something. I wasn't going to agree, but my mum said I should, so I went. And I loved it, and that was effectively the start of my own video business, so, thank you, Mum!

Speaker three

Sometimes it's your friends rather than your family who give the best advice, isn't it? In this case, what had happened was that I'd seen an advertisement for a sofa, and it was less than half price. It was also really rather large and really absolutely red. I wanted to change my apartment around, because I'd just been offered a new job – I know that's not 100 percent logical! Anyway, this large red sofa was delivered – and it was very large. I kept ignoring how big it was but in the end my friend Diana said I should accept that it just looked stupid and made me agree that I'd bought the wrong kind of sofa for my apartment.

Speaker four

When I started college, I was quite shy. At the beginning, I kept wondering if it was all a mistake, if I shouldn't have come at all. My brother came to see me one day and said he wanted to meet all my new friends and I was like: 'What friends?' He thought it was ridiculous, so he told me to make a list of everyone I thought was nice or interesting or something like that and then to ask them all to my room for a party. You know what, every single one accepted and we had a great time and I'm still friends today with at least half of them.

Speaker five

Well, I went on holiday with someone I thought was my best friend. You know, we spent so long planning that trip – the arrangements were more than you needed to get to the moon. But we just didn't get along. We found out we had different, well, opposite, ideas about everything. If I said let's go and do *this*, she'd say let's go and do *that*. We argued a lot. The atmosphere was bad. I called my sister and told her what was going on, said I felt terrible, but she said wipe the slate clean, just go and say you're sorry that it's like this and how could you make it better again? I did, and it worked ... we made up.

Test 6: Listening, Part 4 (page 119)

You will hear an interview with a girl called Steffi Smeeton, who is talking about a group cycling trip she went on.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: My next guest on the travel programme is Steffi Smeeton, who recently returned from a week-long group cycling holiday. Steffi, how did you first hear about the trip?

S: Actually, I'd been hoping to do something like this for a while, and had just been waiting for the right thing to come up. Then I spotted this one on a website. It sounded just the sort of fun thing I was looking for. So I booked a place. It was only later that I realised quite how far I'd have to cycle, and

that's when suddenly I began to have doubts about my level of fitness. But I still went ahead with it though and it all turned out OK in the end.

Int: So what expectations did you go into it with?

S: Well, I'm always up for a challenge, that's just my character, so naturally I was hoping that it would provide that. I guess most of all I wanted to see just how serious I was about cycling. I've always had a bike, and enjoyed it, but I was thinking it might become more important in my life in some way. And, of course, I thought it would be a chance to make contacts amongst like-minded people, although I had no information about who the other group members would be before I left.

Int: How did your family react to the idea?

S: Oh they weren't surprised. In fact, when I was talking about the preparations I needed to make, my elder brother got all excited, and started describing a trip he'd taken. I think it'd been a couple of years previously, not long ago anyway. So he still felt enthusiastic, and even suggested he might join me. We all had to remind him that he's a father now and needs to stay around to look after his new baby. I don't think my sister-in-law would've been thrilled at the prospect of him going.

Int: So who else was in the group?

S: There were about twenty of us. A couple of them had obviously done that sort of thing before – but they showed no signs of impatience with the rest of us who were finding the pace pretty tough. We needed to concentrate on keeping up with those two though. So any chat was left until the evenings, when you needed time to wind down, no matter how exhausted and sleepy you were feeling.

Int: So did you make real friends?

S: I hope so. The problem is that we are all in different places and, well, lead busy lives. Several people were taking photos the whole time, and agreed to email those to everyone. There was some talk of getting together at weekends to keep up with our cycling, but definite plans didn't actually get made. We'll see – maybe we'll sign up for the same ride again next year.

Int: So, looking back, has it changed you?

S: Oh yes. You know what was really interesting for me though? I'm always trying to be very organised, like with my college work and stuff. I set myself all these targets, prioritise and so on and worry whether I'm pulling my weight in any team I'm meant to be part of. But on the bike trip, these things didn't seem quite so important. The pace was just the pace we all rode at, and I stopped trying to calculate our speed and things like that. Maybe that'll carry over into the rest of my life too.

Int: Interesting. And is it all cycling from now on?

S: Oh no. I'm hoping to go flying, I mean in a small plane, and I know I will one day – who knows when – but first I have to go on a 10-kilometre running race I've put my name down for. I'm really not looking forward to that one. Then sailing looks like the next thing on the agenda once that's out of the way. But cycling will always be fun too.

Int: I see. Great talking to you Steffi.

Test 7: Listening, Part 1 (page 134)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a man talking about a childhood holiday.

M: We lived in London, but our grandparents lived in Wales and we all went to stay with them one holiday, my parents and my brother. Wales is absolutely beautiful, but the weather's never that great, which meant that I got really rather bored. Each day we'd plan an activity like swimming in a mountain stream or playing cricket in the garden and each day we'd have to do something else instead when the clouds rolled in off the sea. My brother was in a permanently bad mood, arguing the whole time with my parents about everything – I took no notice of him. Just his age, I guess.

Extract two

You hear part of an interview with a novelist.

M: Your books are usually described as 'romantic novels', but they're grounded in the real world.

F: I like to think so. The people and the events I describe could've happened in the way that I present them to my readers. I stop short of claiming that they did, but I say they're true to life ...

M: Nice distinction.

F: I put in little touches of history, passing references to famous events, to give a sort of flavour of the past. I work hard to make sure it all fits together, calculating in advance what'll happen when x meets y for the first time, how x should react to what y does, or whatever.

Extract three

You hear two characters in a soap opera.

M: Well, I study all day, you know, so that means I'm just stuck in front of a computer screen. Staring.

F: Yes, the modern world isn't really what our bodies were designed for. I don't think in your case that your sight's got any worse since I last saw you.

M: That's good. Because I always think it's a family problem. We're all the same, my parents, both my sisters – all in glasses.

F: Yes, to some extent, short sight's something that we inherit. But as I say, I don't think we need to change your prescription at this point. But make sure you take regular breaks from the computer, won't you?

M: Sure.

Extract four

You hear part of an interview with a teenage celebrity chef.

M: So was it always your ambition to become a chef?

F: I started cooking as a kid. I used to take the school bus home and my stop was in front of this amazing pizza parlour. It always smelled real good, but I only had enough money for the bus. So I'd go home, find a recipe, and make pizza from scratch – the dough, the sauce, everything. Those early pizzas usually tasted great, but one time my dad cracked a tooth on the crust. You live and learn. I used to read cookbooks out loud constantly to my parents like they were comic books; food was just always my thing.

Extract five

You overhear a conversation in a cinema.

M: Well, at least you're here now.

F: Yes, though I thought I wouldn't be able to get in at one point. I just feel I've been very careless. I still don't remember actually dropping it. But obviously I must have.

M: Anyway, don't worry about it now.

F: I suppose it slipped out of my bag earlier, when it started raining and I was looking for my umbrella. I was more concerned about not getting wet than about where I was going. I think the man who checks them on the door thought I was making up some story.

M: At least you had the money to get another one.

F: But it was so embarrassing!

Extract six

You hear part of an interview with a young businessman.

F: Here with me in the studio today is Ken Brunswick, one of the city's most successful businessmen – and one of the youngest. Ken, welcome and thanks for agreeing to come and talk to us today.

M: It's a pleasure. You know, I don't often agree to do interviews. It's not that I don't like them, and anyway I feel I ought to give them, but they do take it out of me actually. I find them exhausting. I know it may sound a bit silly, but I'm so concerned not to just repeat the same ideas each time, that I really do lots of preparation, so they're quite hard work!

Extract seven

You hear a girl talking about a school visit to a recording studio.

F: It was an awesome experience visiting the recording studios. First of all, somebody talked us through all the technical stuff, which some of the boys found really interesting, but it didn't mean much to me. When the band turned up, they were really surprised to meet us, cos nobody had warned them, but they were OK about it, though they didn't have that much to say about what it's like being in a band. Then we actually saw a song being recorded, which made the biggest impression on me cos it was nothing like I thought it'd be actually. It took ages because they kept stopping and starting. I never realised that.

Extract eight

You hear part of an interview with a teenager about health and fitness.

M: Do you have a tip for how to fit exercise into your life? How do you do it?

F: I don't really consider what I do 'exercise'. But I try to not make 'exercising' a chore. I call it 'me time' – time to think. I walk with my mom sometimes, I may run if I feel like it, dance like nobody's watching, bike, hike or swim. It's just thirty minutes to myself. I make space for it and I think everybody owes themselves at least that long each day. How you spend it is your thing. And I also do yoga about three times a week for about twenty minutes.

Test 7: Listening, Part 2 (page 135)

You will hear a man called Lance Arbury telling a group about his job at a zoo.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi, my name's Lance and I work as an animal keeper at the local zoo. I've come along today to tell you about my job and about an upcoming event at the zoo for young people.

So what do I do? I am an animal keeper, and I am responsible for one group of animals at the zoo. I'm lucky enough to have the elephants under my charge, but I'm not just an elephant keeper because I also look after the rhinos and hippos. In fact, I'm officially called the large mammal keeper, because the zoo actually has quite a few different types.

Now you might be wondering what qualifications you need to be a keeper. Well I didn't go to university, so I don't have a degree in zoology, nor did I study veterinary science. The subject I studied is known as zoo biology and I'm a graduate of zoo-keeping college.

On the course I did, you learn about a range of animals – you only specialise once you get a job. So you learn about looking after birds, fish and insects as well. In my case, I got an internship looking after snakes immediately after I qualified. Although it was interesting, I knew I didn't want to do that as a career, and I was glad to get my job here.

So what does my job involve? Although you'd think my first job would be to check out the animals and make sure they're all OK, in fact the night keeper will do that as his last job before going home. So a typical day for me begins with a briefing meeting. That's when I get together with my co-workers to discuss the day's activities.

After that, I go to say good morning to the animals in my charge. They are fed and cleaned all day, but I like to be the one to give them breakfast. For me that is the best part of the day. Other meals will be distributed by my assistants. Another favourite activity is giving the elephants their daily shower – that's always a laugh.

I try to make a difference to the lives of each one in my care, and you form strong bonds with them. For me they are more like family than friends. I guess that's because I deal with big animals that all have characters – perhaps you wouldn't grow so fond of insects or reptiles.

Zoo-keeping is physically demanding, so you have to be fit. In my particular job, you also need to be observant, because I am dealing with intelligent animals, and you never know what they are going to do next. I look out for signs of nervousness or anger and try to find out what's wrong.

Rhinos, for example, have a reputation for being aggressive, but this is not generally true. They are very perceptive intelligent animals and can be trained in much the same way as dogs and horses, to follow commands and so on.

So, if you're interested in a job like mine, the zoo is holding what's known as a Career Discovery Day on November sixth, and anyone over the age of sixteen is welcome to come along. Younger kids can come too – but they need to be accompanied by an adult. There'll be a tour of the zoo and talks from various people who work there. Check-in will begin at 12:30 and the events will start at around one o'clock and go on till four.

Our zoo gets lots of people coming to these events, and numbers are limited, so be sure to register online if you're interested. I'm afraid I can't take applications now because there's a fee of £25 to pay and that has to be done with a credit card. So I guess you'll need to discuss it with your parents.

OK, so before I go on to ...

Test 7: Listening, Part 3 (page 136)

You will hear five short extracts in which students are talking about the best way to study.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) the advice the speaker gives to other students. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

I wouldn't pretend I knew the best way, but I have an idea of what seems to work OK for me. I think you need to be in a good atmosphere, and to try to enjoy yourself – there's no reason for studying to be a hard or miserable thing to do, is there? If you have a friend that you get on with in a relaxed way, try saying you'll do some studying together. Get some snacks to eat – but turn the music off – and get on with it. See how much you can get done in a block of time, say an afternoon, or morning, whatever works best for you.

Speaker two

My problem is not that I don't want to study – because I do – but that I fall asleep very easily. I can't tell you how many times I've sat down to do some studying, felt my eyes get a bit heavy, and the next thing I know I'm waking up an hour or so later. None of my friends will admit to the same problem, so it must just be me. I've learnt, I think, that food really doesn't help, so I try now to study when I'm feeling a bit hungry. It's also useful to avoid getting too comfortable in any way, such as sitting on a sofa or listening to relaxing music.

Speaker three

I don't think there's any one perfect way to study ... some magical solution. You just have to do your best to stay focussed, motivated. A big part of that is being realistic. If you try to read a whole book in one go, it's not going to work. Divide work up into bite-sized chunks that you can handle, like the next ten pages, revising one set of notes, that kind of thing. If you take this step-by-step approach, you can keep going much longer, but you need a pace that you're comfortable with. Otherwise, simple stuff: don't call your friends, don't put the radio on, don't lie on the bed.

Speaker four

I play a lot of sport, and maybe it's because of this that I look at studying as a basically physical thing, something to be in training for, to be fit for. I like to feel awake when I study, so I make sure I do some good physical exercise in the morning, say running, which will clear my mind and get me focussed on studying in the afternoon. I have enough to eat, fruit and so on, so being hungry isn't preventing me from concentrating. I have a good, solid chair and my desk is at the right height and I have a good lamp. These things really help.

Speaker five

The most important thing is being in the right mood. Your favourite band playing in the background can help with this, and clear your mind of other thoughts so that you can just get on with your work. There are people I know who form study clubs with their friends, and then agree they'll do a certain number of hours or sections of book or something in the morning before they're allowed to stop for lunch, but a lot of that seems too, well, scientific for me. And you know, I believe I enjoy the way I study more than a lot of other students enjoy the serious way.

Test 7: Listening, Part 4 (page 137)

You will hear an interview with a man called Jason Phipps, who is a member of a rock band called Well Kept Secret.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: My guest today is Jason Phipps, drummer with the pop band called Well Kept Secret. Jason, first of all, tell us where that name came from.

J: Well, the thing is people think we were trying to sound mysterious or something, but that wasn't the case. When Jordan, the bassist, and me started thinking of putting a new band together, we didn't want everyone to know. The band did have a name then, but we jokingly referred to it with the words 'well kept secret' when we were chatting online or whatever. Even though the whole world pretty soon got to know what we were up to, the name kind of stuck.

Int: But you already had a band – why not use that name?

J: Yeah. Me and Jordan were in another band called Donkey Tears, not a great name, but not so embarrassing either. But when the singer and other guitarist both left, we were looking for new members. When Charley and Declan joined, and we started writing new material, it became clear that the music was going in a new direction – so it seemed the right moment for a new name too, and they were cool with that.

Int: Now that your brand-new album's complete, are you satisfied with it?

J: Yeah – proud of it really – we all feel that. Making it was like a kind of natural process. A lot of bands feel under commercial pressure or worry what the fans will think of the songs, but to be honest we didn't much care. We just made the sort of music we felt like making. It's much easier to be creative that way!

Int: So how does it work – how do you make an album?

J: We all have our parts in writing and that works well. Jordan's the ideas guy who starts the ball rolling with most songs. Charley's an unbelievable guitar player as well as lead singer and he has a huge part in writing the songs too. I guess I'm the guy that takes Jordan's ideas and polishes them, while adding in little touches. I then also work with Declan on the production and arrangement side of things, though he does the electronics and samples.

Int: But the songs are really strong. How do you achieve that?

J: Thanks for the compliment! Even though the songs are full of complicated rhythms and memorable lyrics, there's always a clear message at the core of it all. Actually we generally begin with the title and then start building from that simple concept and then add in all the other aspects. The melody is important, as are some strong lines in the chorus – but it's all got to fit into that original idea.

Int: So at what point do the songs get recorded?

J: Well, we get a rough idea, then we start jamming together and that's when the songs take shape. By the time we get to the studio, we generally know exactly what we want – it's just a question of realising it. At the studio, we always do music first and then vocals after; it's just how we work! Just like any musical project, some songs take a while and some get done really quickly. It varies!

Int: And what about live tours?

J: Well, nothing's finalised yet, but a pretty full schedule is being put together. Just keep checking our networking page for updates. It's gonna be fun, but kind of exhausting. We practise a lot before we play live. We want to make sure people are getting an experience that not just equals but surpasses our album performance. What's the point of seeing a band live if it's just going to be like listening to their album on a big sound system?

Int: Jason, can't wait to hear it. Thanks.

J: Thank you.

Test 8: Listening, Part 1 (page 152)

Now open your question paper and look at Part 1.

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.

For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Extract one

You hear a review of a new pop album.

F: So Ryan, what did you make of the new album by Stoneheart?

M: This is an extremely glossy, well-produced, great-sounding, pop-metal record. The powerful vocals and great melodies combine with deeply personal introspective lyrics that stay with you long after the songs are over. The more you listen, the more they get you thinking. I think this is what really sets it apart from anything they've done before, and from a lot of the similar stuff out there at the moment. It makes for the perfect record to play in your car on a hot summer's night with the windows rolled down.

Extract two

You hear a woman talking on the phone.

F: Look, I'm phoning about the mistake in the booking for the bus to take the volleyball team to the away game. I know nobody's accusing me of anything, but this really wasn't my fault. I've gone through the exchange of emails, and it all seems quite clear to me. I can't understand how the driver managed to end up in the wrong place at the wrong time. I know you said I should apologise to the other team, but isn't that just going to be like an admission of guilt? Can't we just invite them to come and play the match here next week instead? Sorry, but can we talk about this, please?

Extract three

You hear a teenager talking about something he bought.

M: There's lots to choose from, many more than when I first started collecting them. It's interesting that they've become so popular. I guess digital reproduction has made a difference. Well, I think this one's definitely my favourite. I love it ... I think it's really great. The graphics are just so clear, realistic. The colours are fantastic. Each picture is cleverly framed, so the sequence of actions pulls you along, and your eyes move between the speech bubbles and the facial expressions. I actually have to ration myself, to say I'm only allowed a certain number of pages at one go. I'm saving up for the next one already.

Extract four

You overhear a couple talking about playing tennis.

F: I'm really glad we've taken up tennis.

M: Yes, though I don't want to overdo it, pull muscles through trying too hard.

F: That sounds like a great excuse for laziness! We need to practise a lot if we're going to stand a chance of winning the tournament. Cos that is our aim after all.

M: I'm not denying that. But we're meeting people too, which is nice. Anyway, to increase our chances, I suggest we get some new rackets and shoes.

- F:** Let's consider that when we've won the first round, shall we? If we can't win with what we have at the moment, I don't think we'll win with anything.

Extract five

You hear part of an interview with a young website owner.

- F:** So, why did you go into business in the first place?
- M:** Well, my parents are businesspeople, so I grew up assuming it was something you could do. I mean, I never doubted that I was capable of it. But there was no pressure from them. As a teenager, I was always playing around with various different ideas of what I might end up doing. But I didn't concentrate at school quite as much as I should've done, and my teachers weren't too impressed. One in particular told me he didn't think I'd ever make much of myself, and I thought, oh, OK, I'll show you that I can.

Extract six

You hear two students talking about fashion.

- M:** Look there's a piece here about Bryanboy – that guy who writes a blog about fashion.
- F:** Oh right. He's the one who gets invited to all the catwalk shows because he's so influential. They reckon he's really an inspiration for advertising campaigns and even the designers themselves. And when he gets there, he's like a bigger celebrity than some of the models.
- M:** Yeah. I mean it's incredible. He gets like 100,000 hits a day on his site.
- F:** Really? That's interesting. Can I have that page to photocopy? He'd make a really good topic for the project I've got to do on the mass media.
- M:** Sure – take the whole thing. I've finished reading it.

Extract seven

You hear two friends talking about a new art form called 'reverse graffiti'.

- F:** So what do you think of what's called 'reverse graffiti' – you know where instead of spray-painting stuff on walls, they clean off the dirt that collects on old concrete walls and make patterns that way instead.
- M:** Yeah I've seen some. It's not as colourful as traditional graffiti of course, but I guess it is more environmentally friendly. I think it's a shame that people still get into trouble for doing it.
- F:** Yeah, it should be allowed because it can be quite attractive, and it's much more artistic than the usual spray paint stuff.
- M:** Yeah, but I guess the authorities think graffiti's just wrong full stop. But in this case I think they're wrong.

Extract eight

You hear a television scriptwriter talking about her work.

- F:** Young people often ask how they could get into this sort of work. Basically, it's quite a special kind of writing, and you need to know quite a bit about television to do it. So getting a part in a soap opera or a job at the studio's a really good way in. Directors generally know what they want, so you're usually working with quite a specific brief. Seeing how the script on the page is turned into a successful drama will help you see what the scriptwriter has to do. If you watch lots of soaps, you'll get a feel for what works, but on its own that's not enough.

Test 8: Listening, Part 2 (page 153)

You will hear a woman called Angela Newell, who is a vegetarian chef, talking about her career.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have 45 seconds to look at Part 2.

Hi, my name's Angela Newell, and I'm a vegetarian chef. I'm a vegetarian myself, and I also only cook vegetarian food. This evening, I'm going to tell you about my career.

I always loved cooking for my family as a little girl. I did all the usual things like chocolate brownies, my favourite, and pasta with tomatoes – my first main dish. I realised I had talent when I made an apple pie one day that the whole family raved over. From then on, I knew which direction I was heading in.

When I was fifteen, my family moved from the country up to the city. I was surprised how little cooking teenagers did there. Friends were amazed when I said I wanted to do cookery school. In fact the course I ended up doing was about more than cookery. It didn't combine cookery with hotel management or any of the usual things, but instead also had classes in childcare. It wouldn't have been everybody's choice, but it suited me down to the ground as I've always liked kids.

And it turned out to be really useful. It meant that when I was eighteen, I was able to take a one-way ticket to Paris and get a job as a children's nanny. I wasn't an English teacher, but the fact that I could talk to the kids in English meant I was never short of work.

And of course in Paris I was able to study cookery in a serious way. I was only intending to stay two months, but it turned into six. I learnt so much. It was worth more than my whole three-year course back home. Although, I wasn't a vegetarian in those days – that came later. But like all good things, my time in Paris came to an end.

When I got home I applied for lots of jobs, mostly in fancy French restaurants, without success. The job I finally got was on a golf course, not in a smart city-centre hotel as I'd imagined. But it was a busy restaurant and so good training for the job on a cruise ship that came next. That took me all round the world and allowed me to develop my international cookery skills. Indian food was always my personal favourite, even more than French food, but I learnt how to make Chinese and Caribbean dishes too.

It was when I got home that I got a job as a private chef at the home of a well-known fashion model, and her husband who's a journalist. She liked the range of dishes I could cook, but she was a vegetarian. It was from her that my love of vegetarian cookery came, and after two years of working for her I became a vegetarian myself.

We're still friends, and when I left the job she helped me to set up my own vegetarian restaurant. We spent a long time trying to think of a good name for it. We didn't want it to sound too organic, you know a name like Whole Earth or Grass Roots might have kept people away. In the end it was my friend who came up with Green Leaves, which was perfect.

The restaurant's done very well and attracts not only vegetarians, but also lots of other people who like good international food. I was really thrilled when we won an award last year, actually not for the food – though that would've been nice too – but for the quality of the service. I've got some excellent people working for me.

So what's next? The restaurant's going really well, and I've recently published a cookbook including some of my best dishes, and it's selling well. Everyone should be able to cook. That's why I'm also setting up a website soon, so that I can answer questions that people might have about the recipes. I've even been asked to host my own cookery programme on TV, but I'm a bit nervous about that. I've said I'll have to think about it. It'd be exciting though.

Anyway, that's me. Before I go on to ...

Test 8: Listening, Part 3 (page 154)

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about hotels they stayed in.

For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about their hotel. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have 30 seconds to look at Part 3.

Speaker one

I had an OK time at the hotel, though I'm not sure that I'd book it again. I think I'd rather go for something a little nearer the centre. I got the impression that maybe it was under new management. Someone told me that it'd been run by the same family for years, but now a new team had taken over. Anyway, some of the people they had working there seemed a bit out of their depth to be honest. It should all be part of the training, like, they didn't always know the answers to questions, even quite basic things about the facilities, meal times and so on.

Speaker two

It seemed quite expensive for what it was. We didn't eat in the restaurant, for example, because although it was pricey, the menu was quite ordinary. The website talked about the amazing gardens, but they weren't anything special, just somewhere for the kids to play football. It was handy to be near the centre, it's true, not having to catch a bus or taxi, but just wander down. On the other hand, we were on the fourth floor and I do think you could reasonably expect there to be a lift – such a basic facility. Still, the staff were friendly enough, and did their best to make us feel at home.

Speaker three

We were recommended the hotel by some friends who'd once stayed there. They weren't to know that the place was being completely rebuilt this year. The noise was dreadful during the day, so lunch in the restaurant was out of the question. That was no loss really, but some other things were shut all week, like the gym and the swimming pool, which we might've used. Anyway, the kids were happy enough being so close to the beach, I don't think they even noticed the building work and the staff did what they could for us. I think it'll be a nice place once it's all finished.

Speaker four

It was very smart, really well run and everything was just right, as far as I was concerned. I had a lovely big room with a balcony overlooking the gardens. The atmosphere was very quiet and restful, just what I wanted. I was certainly pleased that there didn't seem to be any couples with young kids there. I don't think that's who it's designed for actually. The staff were helpful and friendly, and I quite liked the food in the restaurant, although it wasn't particularly adventurous. I took a taxi into the city one evening to try one of the restaurants there, and that was pretty good.

Speaker five

I spend so much time staying in hotels around the world on business that I hesitate to use them for my own holidays. I find it hard to relax properly in a place that reminds me of my job! But this place was so unlike the typical city-centre hotel that it was great. We spent hours wandering around in the gardens, which were so peaceful and shady. We didn't use the restaurant, which looked very formal, but had the staff bring us meals in our room. There were several families with kids staying there too, and I think they made good use of the pool and play area – though we didn't use those facilities ourselves.

Test 8: Listening, Part 4 (page 155)

You will hear an interview with a rap musician called Joey Small, who has just started a new career as a movie actor.

For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part 4.

Int: My guest today is Joey Small, a rap singer who's just got his first big break as a movie actor. Joey, tell us about the movie.

J: Hi. I play a teenager who's really into roller-skating. I wanted to do it because it's something new and I like to give people the unexpected. It was a challenge for me, the acting, and trying to do that and the skating at the same time was awesome. But the toughest part was just getting used to the routine on set. The early starts, the retakes. You don't get any of that in rap! But it went great.

Int: You look like a very good roller-skater. Was it really you?

J: Sure was. Actually, I'm from the Midwest. We do a lot of skating there, so I already had some skills. But because the movie's set in the 1970s, the skates had to be old-fashioned ones. I mean, I learnt on inline skates, and there's a different technique involved. But it was cool once you got the hang of it. We had coaches help us do things, though, but I was a little more advanced than the other guys, so could pull off some of the moves a bit sooner than them.

Int: Was it fun doing a movie set in the 1970s?

J: Well, we had to do a lot of homework. We were told to watch all these old seventies movies and TV shows and talk like people did in those days. Some of the actors couldn't do it without laughing, but I was OK with it. And there were acting coaches who really prepared us – they made all the difference, and you had to do what they said. And we had to wear funny seventies clothes, though people said I looked quite cool in them actually.

Int: And what about working with Laurel Bryton, who plays your mum in the film?

J: Well, people say she's not an easy person to work with; that she's unfriendly. But I reckon that's unfair. She was by my side through the whole thing and I know I couldn't have pulled it off if it hadn't been for her. I'm really not an advice person; I like to do everything my own way. That's just how I am: I'm my own type of dude. But I listened to Laurel, cos she knows what she's doing.

Int: What advice do you have for kids wanting to get into acting?

J: Well, basically you learn what you have to say, and you try to get it right. But you can always retake a scene if you mess up. More important, you've got to use your ears – listen to the words as you say them, otherwise they won't sound natural. That's what I picked up from Laurel and it worked. I don't think the average person would really understand what she was talking about, cos I didn't either. But after I did it, I definitely got what she was saying.

Int: What's it like for a kid your age dealing with fame?

J: I just try to make the best of it. Sometimes I don't feel like being bothered, when I'm not working and people come up to me. But you gotta be polite. Some people respect your privacy and some don't. But hey, it's our job. We always like the front end of it, when people go buy our records, our movies. And we like to buy the cars, the homes and jewellery and stuff like that. Loss of privacy's the price you pay. I don't have a problem with that.

Int: And what of the future?

J: Well, it'd be cool to think I'll be offered more movies, but I'm not counting on it. If it comes, it comes – and in any case it needs to be the right thing. I guess I'm a rapper at heart and I wouldn't like to give that up in favour of acting. But who knows, maybe there's another avenue just about to open up for me – something I haven't even considered yet. I'm only nineteen, so I'm not closing any doors yet!